Metals Market Index MMI

MMi Dashboard

Iron Ore Price Indices

Iron Ore Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPI62 62% Fe Fines RMB/t

807
-14 -1.71%
Dec 20th, 2022

Iron Ore Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPI65 65% Fe Fines RMB/t

919
-25.00 -2.65%
Dec 20th, 2022

Iron Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPI58 58% Fe Fines RMB/t

727
0 0.00%
Dec 20th, 2022

Iron Ore Seaborne (CFR Qingdao)
IOSI62 62% Fe Fines USD/dmt

110.40
0.15 0.14%
Dec 20th, 2022

Iron Ore Seaborne (CFR Qingdao)
IOSI65 65% Fe Fines USD/dmt

114.75
-1.05 -0.91%
Dec 20th, 2022

Iron Ore Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPLI 62.5% Fe Lump RMB/t

920
-10 -1.08%
Week Ending Dec 16th, 2022

Exchange Traded Contracts

DCE Iron Ore 62% Fines
I2305 (Jan) RMB/t (3pm close)

804.50
11.00 1.39%
Dec 20th, 2022 (3pm close)

SGX Iron Ore (CFR Qingdao) 62% Fe Fines
January 23 USD/dmt

109.15
1.40 1.30%
Dec 20th, 2022 (5.30 pm Print)

SHFE Rebar
RB2305 (Jan) RMB/t

3939
12 0.31%
Dec 20th, 2022 (3pm close)

Freight Rates

C3, Tubarao - Qingdao USD/t

21.40
0.12 0.57%
Dec 19th, 2022

C5, W. Australia - Qingdao USD/t

8.10
-0.53 -6.14%
Dec 19th, 2022

Steel Price

Steel Rebar (China Domestic) RMB/t

4010
160 4.16%
Week Ending Dec 16th, 2022

Inventory Levels

Iron Ore Inventory at Chinese Ports (35)
million tonnes

130.63
0.19 0.15%
Week Ending Dec 16th, 2022

Steel Inventory in China
million tonnes

8.71
-0.17 -1.95%
Week Ending Dec 16th, 2022

Steel Price

Steel HRC (China Domestic) RMB/t

4140
70 1.72%
Week Ending Dec 16th, 2022

IRON ORE PORT STOCK INDEX (IOPI)

Dec 20th, 2022		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne [1]						
Index	Fe Content	Price	Change	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]	Price	Change	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]
IOPI62	62% Fe Fines	807	-14	-1.7%	758	863	643	1083	107.26	-2.11	-1.9%	100.48	120.39	82.29	159.06
IOPI58	58% Fe Fines	727	0	0.0%	678	732	567	907	97.30	-0.16	-0.2%	90.42	102.30	77.29	134.15
IOPI65	65% Fe Fines	919	-25	-2.6%	888	1020	811	1265	122.68	-3.65	-2.9%	118.24	142.94	108.78	187.25

IRON ORE SEABORNE INDEX (IOSI)

Dec 20th, 2022		CFR Qingdao, USD/dry tonne						
Index	Fe Content	Price	Change	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]
IOSI62	62% Fe Fines	110.40	0.15	0.14%	101.31	122.60	83.90	159.45
IOSI65	65% Fe Fines	114.75	-1.05	-0.91%	111.61	140.93	94.45	185.82

MARKET COMMENTARY

DCE iron ore futures rose by 0.19% today, the main contract closed 804.5. The traders' willingness to ship is less.The steel mills are wait and see.The overall trading sentiment of the market is worse. PBF at Shandong port dealt 806-808 yuan/mt; PBF at Tangshan port dealt 818 yuan/mt,increase 3-4 yuan/mt. According to SMM statistics, the impact of blast furnace maintenance on molten iron this week was 179.63 tons, down 96400 tons month on month compared with last week. The impact of blast furnace maintenance on molten iron next week will rise slightly. According to the amount of iron water this week, the demand for iron ore may increase. At present, although the profits of steel plants have been repaired, most of them are at the edge of loss or profit and loss. The rhythm of steel plants' winter storage is still dominated by slow replenishment on demand. However, considering the downturn of terminal demand and the disturbance of epidemic situation, the price of iron ore is still subject to wide fluctuations in the short term.

IRON ORE PORT LUMP INDEX (IOPLI)

Week Ending Dec 16th, 2022		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne [3]						
Index	Fe Content	Price	W-o-W	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]	Price	W-o-W	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]
IOPLI62	62.5% Fe Lump	920	-10	-1.1%	873	1048	770	1405	118.15	-0.87	-0.73%	111.45	141.12	94.72	199.13

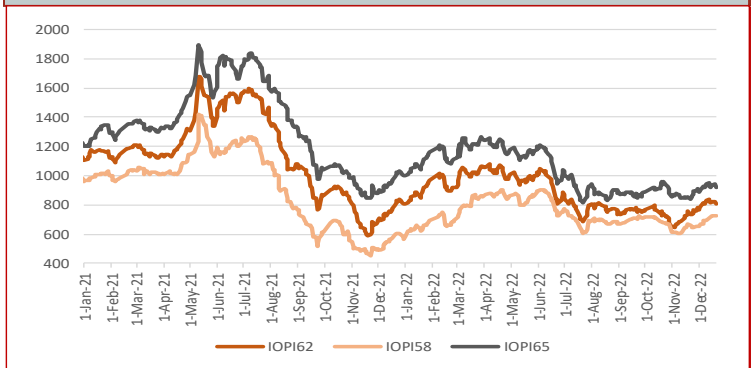
IRON ORE DOMESTIC CONCENTRATE SPOT PRICE ASSESSMENTS AND COMPOSITE INDEX

Week Ending Dec 16th, 2022				RMB/tonne (excluding tax) [3]				USD/tonne (excluding tax) [3]			
Province	Region	Product	Basis	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
Hebei	Hanxing	66% Fe Concentrate	Dry	992	3.9%	779	1645	142.54	4.27%	110.31	255.69
Hebei	Qian'an	65% Fe Concentrate	Dry	1020	2.0%	780	1630	146.56	2.39%	110.51	251.57
Liaoning	Anshan	65% Fe Concentrate	Wet	740	4.2%	620	1310	106.33	4.62%	87.40	202.32
Shandong	Zibo	65% Fe Concentrate	Dry	1015	3.8%	800	1752	145.84	4.18%	117.19	272.32

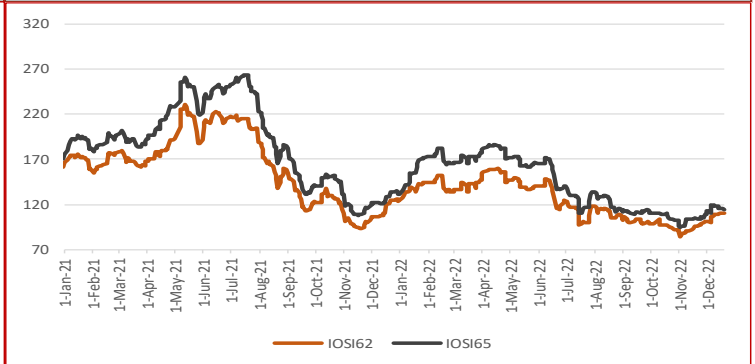
Week Ending Dec 16th, 2022	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
China Mines Concentrate Composite Index RMB/WT	883.25	3.51%	706.36	1511.22

[1] Exchange rate applied: RMB/USD = 6.7522 [2] Last 12 months
[3] Weekly exchange rate applied: RMB/USD =6.9596

IRON ORE PORT INDEX, FOT QINGDAO (RMB/WT)



IRON ORE SEABORNE INDEX, CFR QINGDAO (USD/DMT)



IRON ORE PORT STOCK INDEX MONTHLY, QUARTERLY AND YEAR-TO-DATE AVERAGES

Dec 20th, 2022		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne						
Index	Fe Content	August	September	October	November	MTD	QTD	YTD	August	September	October	November	MTD	QTD	YTD
IOPI62	62% Fe Fines	781	759	736	714	758	760	863	106.64	101.14	95.56	92.18	100.48	101.47	120.39
IOPI58	58% Fe Fines	685	697	683	635	678	679	732	94.05	93.56	89.34	82.39	90.42	91.14	102.30
IOPI65	65% Fe Fines	878	875	918	865	888	893	1020	120.31	117.19	120.08	112.37	118.24	119.76	142.94

IRON ORE SEABORNE INDEX MONTHLY, QUARTERLY AND YEAR-TO-DATE AVERAGES

Dec 20th, 2022		CFR Qingdao, USD/dry tonne						
Index	Fe Content	August	September	October	November	MTD	QTD	YTD
IOSI62	62% Fe Fines	110.64	101.12	95.80	93.05	101.31	102.81	122.60
IOSI65	65% Fe Fines	112.53	111.57	106.70	102.40	111.61	113.83	140.93

FREIGHT RATES

Dec 19th, 2022		FREIGHT RATES - DRY BULK US$/wet tonne				
Route	Designation		Change	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
W. Australia - Qingdao	C5	8.10	-0.53	-6.14%	3.57	16.77
Tubarao - Qingdao	C3	21.40	0.12	0.57%	6.70	36.40

IRON ORE PORT LUMP INDEX MONTHLY, QUARTERLY AND YEAR-TO-DATE AVERAGES

Week Ending Dec 16th, 2022		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne [1]						
Index	Fe Content	August	September	October	November	MTD	QTD	YTD	September	October	October	November	MTD	QTD	YTD
IOPLI62	62.5% Fe Lump	900	873	877	811	873	880	1048	118.50	112.75	109.81	100.83	111.45	113.31	141.12

IRON ORE INDEX PREMIUMS/DISCOUNTS

Dec 20th, 2022		PORT STOCK INDEX (RMB/WT)	
Index	Fe Content	Spread to IOPI62	% Spread to IOPI62
IOPI58	58% Fe Fines	-80	-9.91%
IOPI65	65% Fe Fines	112	13.88%

Dec 20th, 2022		SEABORNE INDEX (USD/DMT)	
Index	Fe Content	Spread to IOSI62	% Spread to IOSI62
IOSI65	65% Fe Fines	4.35	3.94%

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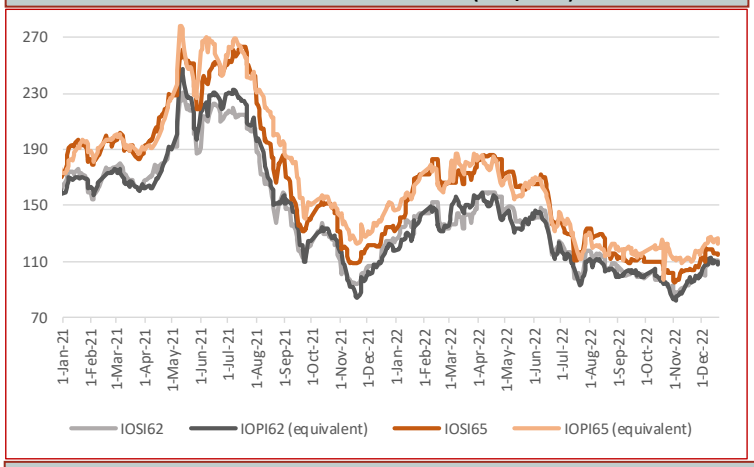
IRON ORE INDEX COMPARISONS (USD/DMT)



CHINA DOMESTIC COMPOSITE MINES INDEX (RMB/Wet Tonne, including VAT)

IRON ORE BRAND SPOT PRICE ASSESMENTS

Dec 20th, 2022	PORT STOCK INDEX (RMB/WT)		
	Price	Change	Diff to IOPI62
Roy Hill	750	-14	-57
SIMEC Fines	678	-14	-129
PB Fines	776	-14	-31
Newman Fines	775	-14	-32
MAC Fines	757	-14	-50
Jimblebar Blended Fines	671	-14	-136
Carajas Fines	987	-14	180
Brazilian SSF	770	-14	-37
Brazilian Blend Fines	789	-14	-18
RTX Fines	690	-14	-117
West Pilbara Fines	719	-13	-88

Dec 20th, 2022	SEABORNE INDEX (USD/DMT)		
	Price	Change	Diff to IOSI62
Roy Hill	105.90	0.15	-4.50
SIMEC Fines	102.40	0.15	-8.00
PB Fines	106.65	0.15	-3.75
Newman Fines	109.55	0.20	-0.85
MAC Fines	106.65	0.15	-3.75
Jimblebar Blended Fines	99.05	0.20	-11.35
Carajas Fines	139.95	0.15	29.55
Brazilian SSF	114.15	0.15	3.75
Brazilian Blend Fines	115.80	0.20	5.40
RTX Fines	100.30	0.20	-10.10
West Pilbara Fines	104.65	0.15	-5.75

Dec 20th, 2022	PORT STOCK INDEX (RMB/WT)		
	Price	Change	Diff to IOPI58
SSF	727	0	0
FMG Blended Fines	736	0	9
Robe River	737	0	10
Western Fines	739	0	12
Atlas Fines	734	0	7
Yandi	720	0	-7

IRON ORE INDEX NORMALISATION DIFFERENTIALS

Port Stock Index Product Differentials (RMB/wet tonne)

	Applicable range	Value	Change
1% Fe	High Grade Fe 60 - 63%	29.00	0.00
	High Grade Fe 63 - 64%	39.00	5.00
	High Grade Fe 64 - 65%	39.00	5.00
	High Grade Fe 65 - 65.5%	39.00	5.00
	Low Grade Fe	19.00	2.00
1% Alumina	High Fe Grade Al <2.25%	96.00	5.00
	High Fe Grade Al 2.25-4%	43.00	5.00
	Low Fe Grade Al <2.25%	43.00	-5.00
	Low Fe Grade Al 2.25-4%	14.00	3.00
1% Silica	High Fe Grade Si <4%	44.00	2.00
	High Fe Grade Si 4-6.5%	40.00	-2.00
	Low Fe Grade	10.00	3.00
0.01% Phosphorus	High Fe Grade 0.09%<P<0.115%	21.00	3.00
	High Fe Grade 0.115%<P<0.15%	21.00	3.00
	Low Fe Grade 0.09<P<0.1%	5.00	0.00

Seaborne Index Product Differentials (USD/dry tonne)

	Applicable range	Value	Change
1% Fe	High Grade Fe 60 - 63%	2.25	0.00
	High Grade Fe 63 - 64%	0.25	0.00
	High Grade Fe 64 - 65%	0.25	0.00
	High Grade Fe 65 - 65.5%	0.25	0.00
1% Alumina	High Fe Grade Al <2.25%	0.50	0.00
	High Fe Grade Al 2.25-4%	2.25	0.00
1% Silica	High Fe Grade Si <4%	0.25	0.00
	High Fe Grade Si 4 - 6.5%	2.00	0.00
0.01% Phosphorus	High Fe Grade 0.09%<P<0.115%	1.25	0.00
	High Fe Grade 0.115%<P<0.15%	2.75	0.00

Port Stock Price Differentials to Qingdao Port for PB Fines (RMB/wet tonne)

Port	Value	Change	Port	Value	Change	Port	Value	Change	Port	Value	Change
Bayuquan	-100.00	0.00	Fangcheng	-25.00	0.00	Lanshan	0.00	0.00	Rizhao	0.00	0.00
Beilun	0.00	0.00	Jiangyin	-30.00	0.00	Lianyungang	0.00	0.00	Shekou	0.00	0.00
Caofeidian	-10.00	0.00	Jingtang	-20.00	0.00	Majishan	0.00	0.00	Taicang	-30.00	0.00
Dalian	0.00	0.00	Lanqiao	0.00	0.00	Qingdao	0.00	0.00	Tianjin	-10.00	0.00

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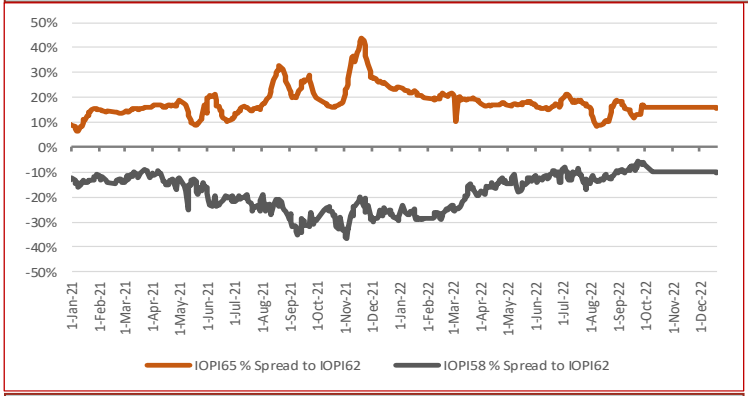
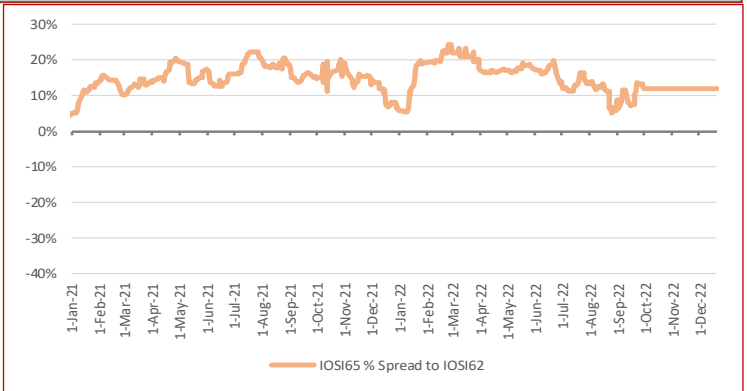
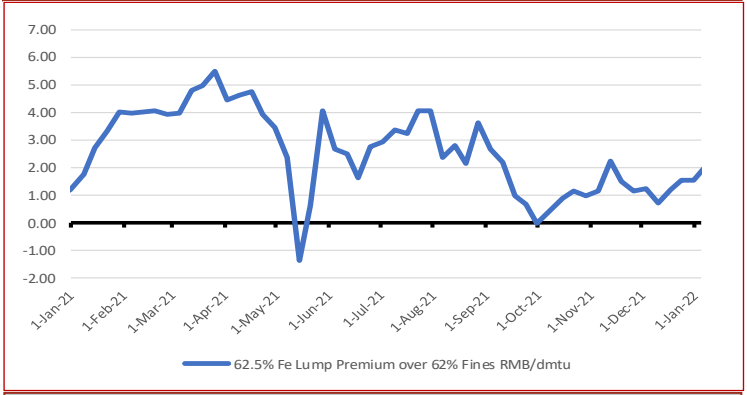
IRON ORE INDEX PREMIUMS/DISCOUNTS

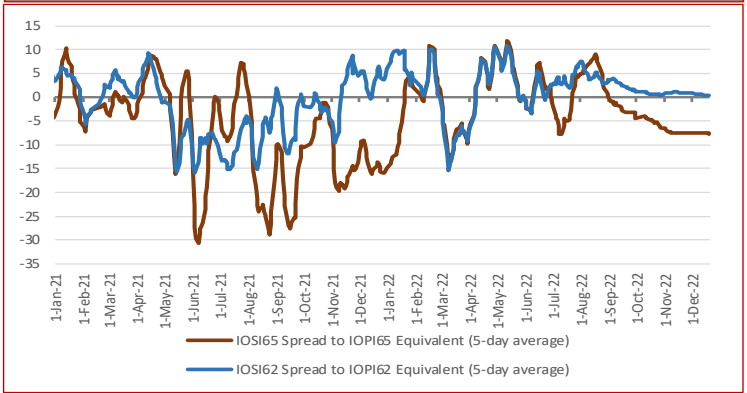




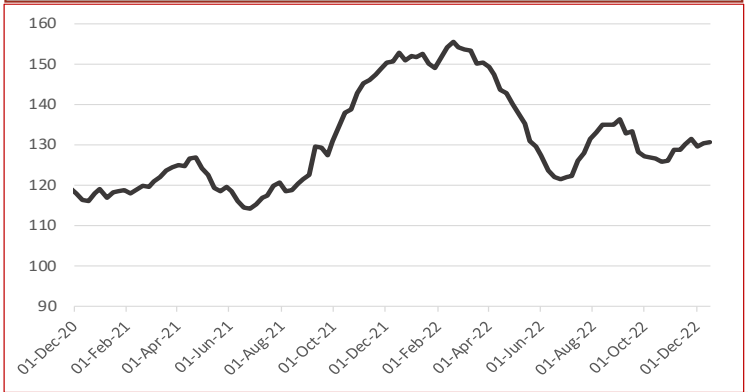
WEEKLY IRON ORE PORT STOCK LUMP PREMIUM (RMB/DMTU)



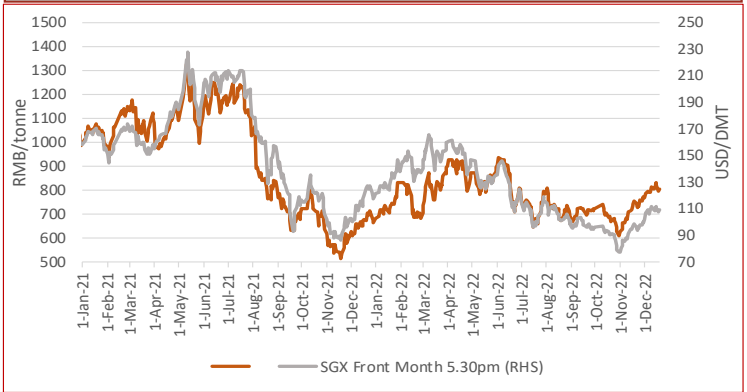
IRON ORE SEABORNE TO PORT STOCK PRICE SPREADS (USD/DMT)



TOTAL IRON ORE INVENTORIES AT CHINA PORTS (MILLION TONNES)



FUTURE TRADING—FRONT MONTH CLOSING PRICE



IRON ORE PORT INVENTORIES (MILLION TONNES)

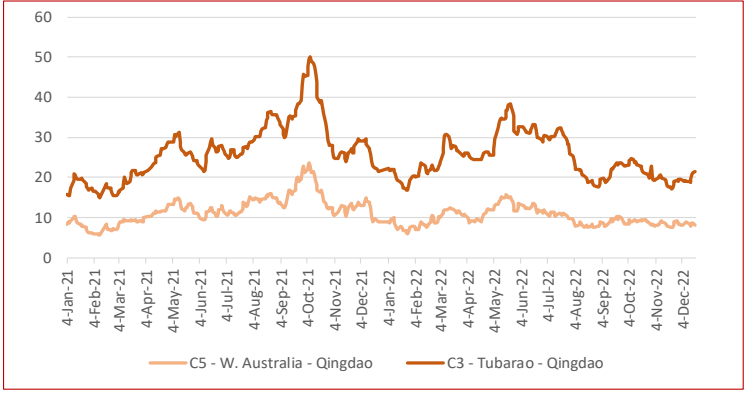
Week Ending Dec 16th, 2022

Province	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
Jingtang	12.78	-1.54%	9.84	19.20
Qingdao	25.74	2.75%	9.41	26.24
Caofeidian	12.38	0.41%	9.05	16.29
Tianjin	9.31	3.67%	7.14	12.97
Rizhao	17.47	-0.85%	9.44	19.26
Total (35 Ports)	130.63	0.15%	98.80	155.39

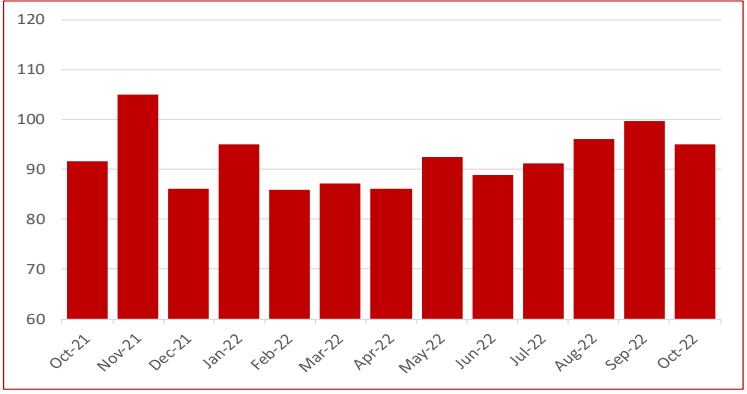
IRON ORE FUTURES CONTRACTS

	DCE (RMB/WMT)			SGX (USD/DMT)		
Closing Date	Dec 20th, 3pm close			Dec 20th, 5:30pm		
Contract	I2305	Change	Change %	Jan. 23	Change	Change %
Closing Price	804.50	11.00	1.39%	109.15	1.40	1.30%
Vol traded ('000 lots)	82.19	-27.01	-24.73%	3.47	-0.22	-6.06%
Open positions ('000 lots)	79.31	1.90	2.45%	32.38	-0.24	-0.73%
Day Low	788.0	-4.00	-0.51%	107.40	0.20	0.19%
Day High	810.0	-11.50	-1.40%	109.95	-1.35	-1.21%

DRY BULK FREIGHT RATES (USD/MT)



TOTAL CHINA IRON ORE IMPORT VOLUMES (MILLION TONNES)



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STEEL SPOT MARKET PRICES—CHINA

Steel Spot Market RMB/tonne

Product	2022/12/16	Change	Change %
ReBar HRB400 ϕ18mm	4,010	160	4.16%
Wirerod Q300 ϕ6.5mm	4,280	60	1.42%
HRC Q235/SS400 5.5mm*1500*C	4,140	70	1.72%
CRC SPCC/ST12 1.0mm*1250*2500	4,560	120	2.70%
Medium & Heavy Plate Q235B 20mm	4,190	120	2.95%
GI ST02Z 1.0mm*1000*C	4,850	120	2.54%
Colour Coated Plate	7,530	80	1.07%

CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY

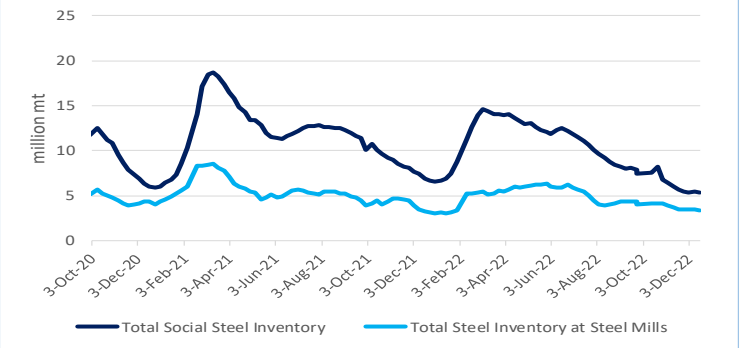
SMM Tracking of Steel Mill P&L - Rebar and Hot-rolled Coil (RMB/tonne)

Category	Price	Change (WoW)	Note
MMi (Fe 62%), USD/mt exluding tax	110.25	3	Mmi CFR Equivalent index for 1st Feb
Coke	3,070	110	2nd grade met coke, Tangshan, incl. tax
Steel Scrap	3,090	80	steel scrap (6mm) in Zhangjiagang, exl. tax
Billet Cost	3,736	74	Q234, incl. tax
Rebar cost - Blast furnace	4,255	84	calculated based on theoretical weight, incl. tax
Rebar profit - Blast furnace	-255	66	based on Shanghai prices, incl. tax
Hot-rolled coil cost - Blast furnace	4,216	82	based on actual weight, incl. tax
Hot-rolled coil proft - Blast furnace	-76	-12	based on Shanghai prices, incl. tax

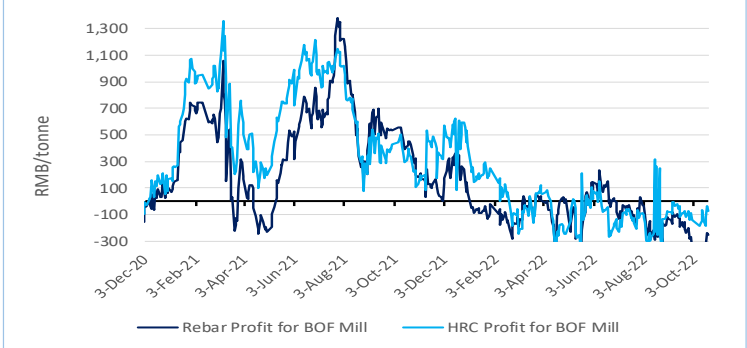
Note: 1. Costs in the table are caluclated based on todays market prices and facout our management, sales, financial and depreciations fe

2. The cost refers to average cost in the industry based on SMM's survey of small, medium and large mills in China

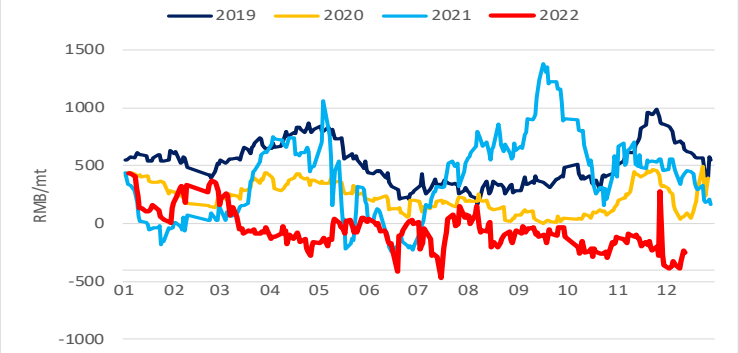
CHINESE STEEL INVENTORIES



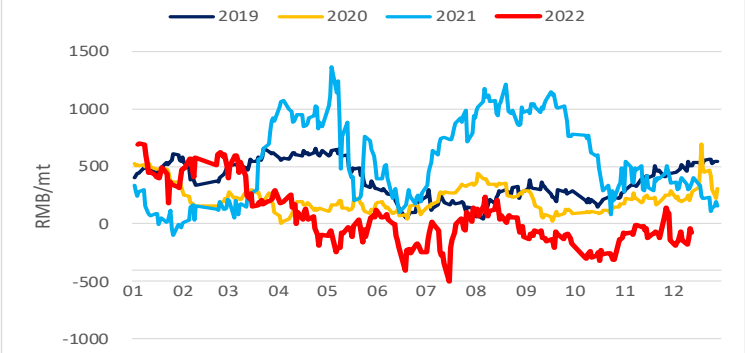
CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY



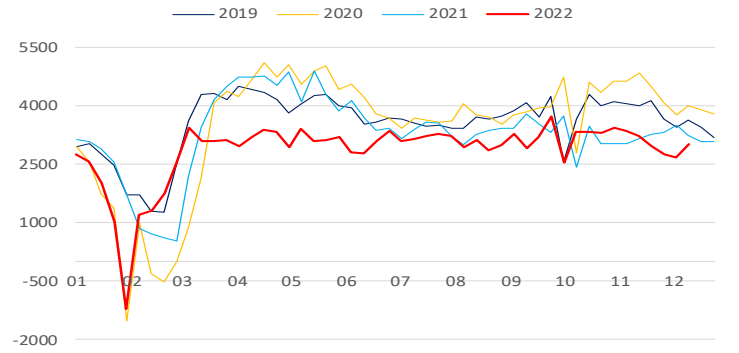
CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY—Rebar



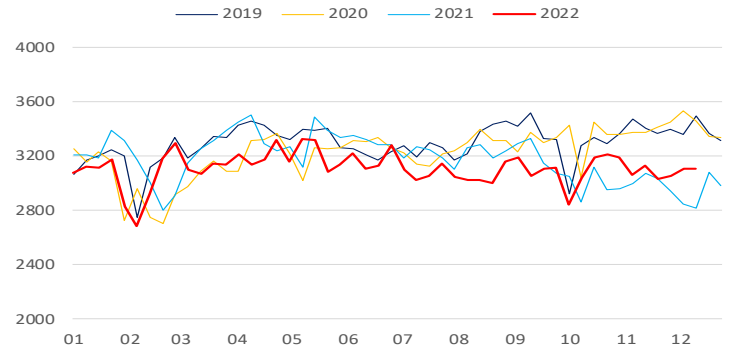
CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY—Hot-rolled Coil



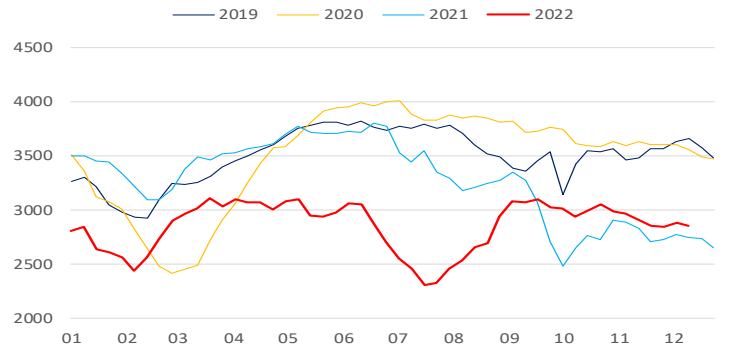
CHINESE STEEL CONSUMPTION—Rebar



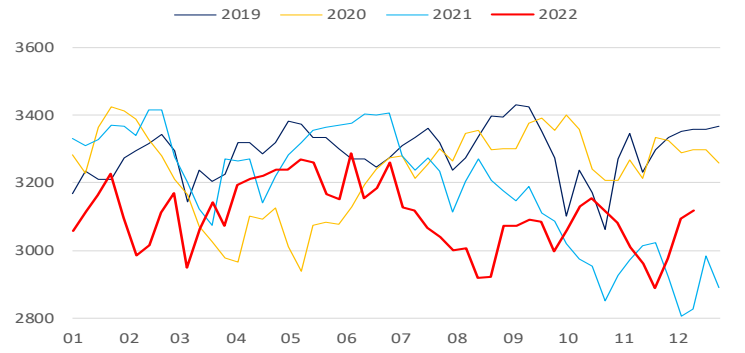
CHINESE STEEL CONSUMPTION—Hot-rolled Coil



CHINESE STEEL PRODUCTION—Rebar



CHINESE STEEL PRODUCTION—Hot-rolled Coil



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IRON ORE INDEX SPECIFICATIONS, COMPILATION RATIONALE AND DATA EXCLUSIONS

Iron Ore Index Specifications (Port and Seaborne)

	65% Fe Fines	62% Fe Fines	58% Fe Fines	62.5% Fe Lump
Fe %	65.00	62.00	58.00	62.50
Alumina %	1.40	2.25	2.25	1.50
Silica%	1.50	4.00	5.50	3.50
Phosphorus %	0.06	0.09	0.05	0.08
Sulphur %	0.01	0.02	0.02	0.02
Moisture %	8.00	8.00	9.00	4.00
Sizing	Granular size below 10mm for at least 90% of cargo; maximum of 40% below 150 micron			Size below 6.3mm max 15% Size above 31.15mm max 25%
Pricing Point	Qingdao Port (FOT and CFR respectively)			FOT Qingdao Port
Timing (Seaborne)	Loading within 4 weeks, Delivery within 8 weeks			Delivery within 2 weeks
Payment Terms	L/C at sight			L/C at sight or CAD

Iron Ore Index Compilation Rationale and Data Exclusions

MMi iron ore indices are compiled from data provided by companies that are part of the iron ore supply chain and involved in spot market transactions. The indices are calculated using detailed transaction-level data submitted to MMi by these companies. This data is normalised to the appropriate specifications and screened to remove outliers before volume-weighted average prices are calculated from the remaining core set of data.

For more details on MMi's iron ore methodology please download the guide published on our website at: www.mmiprices.com

Data Exclusions*

	62%	58%	65%
Port Index	0	0	0
Seaborne index	0		0
Lump Index 62.5	0		

* Number of price submissions for iron ore indices that were excluded from index calculations today as they were anomalous and could not be verified

IRON ORE DOMESTIC CONCENTRATE INDEX CALCULATION METHODOLOGY

The compilation method for price index generally refers to the compilation method of CPI price index and other price indices, breakdown the price data and calculate the average value according to a certain method, taking the vertical axis as the regional composite index (average of different grade index) and the horizontal axis as the grade composite index (average of different regional index), a total composite index for domestic ore can be output ultimately. The process system is also adopted in the calculation i.e. each sub-index can be obtained as well.

AVERAGE IRON ORE SPECIFICATIONS APPLIED FOR BRAND PRICE ASSESSMENTS

PORT STOCK BRANDS

Dec 20th, 2022	Specifications applied for 62% brand assessments				
	Fe	Alumina	Silica	Phos	Moisture
Roy Hill	60.88%	2.35%	4.45%	0.055%	9.26%
SIMEC Fines	60.00%	2.30%	6.30%	0.060%	6.00%
PB Fines	61.64%	2.31%	3.87%	0.099%	9.45%
Newman Fines	62.49%	2.31%	3.98%	0.090%	7.72%
MAC Fines	60.43%	2.38%	4.64%	0.078%	7.57%
Jimblebar Blended Fines	60.87%	2.95%	4.53%	0.111%	7.32%
Carajas Fines	64.90%	1.39%	1.82%	0.080%	7.78%
Brazilian SSF	62.00%	1.00%	6.50%	0.040%	6.00%
Brazilian Blend Fines	62.56%	1.58%	4.79%	0.091%	8.72%
RTX Fines	61.00%	3.10%	4.50%	0.135%	7.50%
West Pilbara Fines	60.10%	2.30%	4.70%	0.075%	8.50%

Dec 20th, 2022	Specifications applied for 58% brand assessments				
	Fe	Alumina	Silica	Phos	Moisture
SSF	56.49%	3.20%	6.19%	0.065%	9.18%
FMG Blended Fines	58.20%	2.43%	5.54%	0.057%	8.29%
Robe River	56.44%	3.16%	5.73%	0.042%	8.44%
Western Fines	57.88%	2.87%	7.50%	0.062%	7.45%
Atlas Fines	58.00%	1.85%	5.50%	0.090%	9.00%
Yandi	56.87%	1.58%	6.41%	0.042%	9.53%

SEABORNE BRANDS

	Specifications applied for 62% brand assessments				
	Fe	Alumina	Silica	Phos	Moisture
Roy Hill	60.70%	2.30%	4.90%	0.055%	8.00%
SIMEC Fines	60.00%	2.30%	6.30%	0.060%	6.00%
PB Fines 62%	62.00%	2.60%	4.30%	0.090%	9.50%
Newman Fines	62.30%	2.40%	4.30%	0.095%	8.00%
MAC Fines	60.80%	2.35%	4.40%	0.075%	7.80%
Jimblebar Blended Fines	60.50%	3.10%	4.80%	0.120%	7.80%
Carajas Fines	65.10%	1.50%	1.70%	0.080%	8.50%
Brazilian SSF	62.00%	1.00%	6.50%	0.040%	6.00%
Brazilian Blend Fines	63.00%	1.50%	5.00%	0.070%	7.00%
RTX Fines	61.00%	3.10%	4.50%	0.135%	7.50%
West Pilbara Fines	60.10%	2.30%	4.70%	0.075%	8.50%

BLOOMBERG TICKERS

PORT STOCK INDICES

	FOT Qingdao (RMB/wet tonne)	CFR Qingdao Equivalent (USD/dry tonne)
IOPI62	IRCNQ001	IRCNQ004
IOPI58	IRCNQ002	IRCNQ005
IOPI65	IRCNQ003	IRCNQ006
IOPLI62	IRCN0036	IRCN0037

SEABORNE INDICES

	CFR Qingdao (USD/DMT)
IOSI62	IRCN0034
IOSI65	IRCN0035

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